

of tracking even the minutest aspects such as transportation costs from place A to place B.

Even demand prediction is an important advantage of Big Data and analytics over raw agriculture data.

"With Big Data applied, farmers can adjust their harvest based on the upcoming demand. If they have the right information, they can decide to sell immediately, store or preserve the produce in case it is perishable. Planting decisions can be made based on long-term forecasts," advises Dr Regi.

In summary, Big Data and analytics empower farmers with the right knowledge to find easy and legal sales channels offering the best prices for their produce.

"During the times of actual produce scarcity, prices go up and farmers switch crops. This leads to abundance in the next cycle and price crash. The cycle repeats and farmers face crisis one after another. Such situations can be avoided if



e-NAM portal of the government of India

intelligence is shared with farmers in advance. The role of data analytics and Big Data is invaluable here."

Smart marketplace models: The easiest to develop and deploy

Data scientists and IoT researchers believe that the easiest solution to the problem is deployment of smart marketplace models wherein farmers are constantly e-connected with

companies interested in purchasing agricultural produce.

The biggest advantage of this system is that prevailing market prices are communicated dynamically to farmers via Big Data and analytics as soon as the conversation is initiated. This information included geographical location of the farm in which the produce is harvested, the fertility of the farm,



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